



CITIPOINTE CHURCH · NASHVILLE · FRANKLIN

Lifegroups Leader Training Booklet

Fall Season 2026

Our Lifegroups exist to make disciples by gathering people around Jesus in homes throughout our city.

FOR THE GLORY OF GOD AND FOR THE SAKE OF THE WORLD

Our Lifegroups exist to make disciples by gathering people around Jesus in homes throughout our city. Following the example found in Scripture, we devote ourselves to God's Word, prayer, fellowship, the breaking of bread, and caring for one another, so that Christ is glorified and His love is made visible to the world.

This is the sentence everything else hangs off. Every run sheet, every standard, every commitment in this booklet exists to serve that one paragraph. If you ever lose the thread of what you are doing on a Wednesday night, come back to this page.

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THE SEASON

Sunday 16 August

Lifegroup sign ups go live

Wednesday 2 September

Season launch night

Wednesday 18 November

Last night of the season

01

The why

Why every group now meets on the same night, and what we are aiming at when we do.

The table is the strategy.

ONE NIGHT

THE LEADER'S WIN

THE MODEL

OUR PROMISE

One night, one rhythm, one church.

From this season, every Lifegroup meets on a Wednesday night, in homes, with the same shape to the evening. Homes, tables, food, Scripture, prayer, Communion.

That does something a scattered calendar never could. Anyone we meet on a Sunday can be invited into a Lifegroup on Wednesday, and we can tell them exactly what they are walking into. The whole church is around a table on the same evening, praying for the same city, in dozens of homes at once.

It carries you, too. Every other leader is preparing for the same night, and living the same week you are. When something is hard, there is someone a few streets over doing the same thing at the same hour.

And it gives you fewer decisions to make. You are not designing a format, you are shepherding people. Everything you have goes into the part that actually matters: the table, the Word, and the people around it.

The table is the strategy.

You are not running a program.

You will not be measured by attendance, by how well you teach, or by how tidy the house was. Three things make a win.

01 Welcoming environment

People walk in and feel like they were expected. The door, the food, the first five minutes. Most of whether someone comes back is decided before the study ever starts.

02 Community

People are known by name and missed when they are not there. Conversation moves around the room rather than through you.

03 Intentional discipleship

Something is actually happening in people. They are further along in Christ in November than they were in September, and you could tell someone specifically how.

If those three are true, the night was a win, whether six people came or sixteen.

THE MODEL

"Every day they continued to meet together in the temple courts. They broke bread in their homes and ate together with glad and sincere hearts, praising God and enjoying the favor of all the people. And the Lord added to their number daily those who were being saved."

ACTS 2:46-47

We did not invent this. We are following the example found in Scripture.

Lifegroups are dinner parties with Christ at the center. They meet in homes, on Wednesday nights, in seasons. People eat together, talk properly, open the Bible, pray for each other, and take Communion.

A home is not a fallback for a church that ran out of rooms. It is the setting the New Testament actually describes, and it does something a room in a building cannot. You cannot be anonymous at someone's kitchen table.

THREE SEASONS A YEAR

Spring

February to April

Summer

June to July

Fall

September to
November

Groups run in seasons so there is always a fresh moment to jump in, and a break to catch your breath. This season launches Wednesday 2 September and finishes Wednesday 18 November.

Eight commitments every group keeps.

Whichever home it meets in, whoever gathers around the table.

01 **Two approved leaders**

Be led by two approved leaders, sharing the responsibility of shepherding the group.

02 **Two leaders in training**

Intentionally develop two leaders in training, raising up who leads next.

03 **Meet in homes**

Meet in a home or apartment complex whenever possible, where hospitality feels natural.

04 **Christ at the center**

Take Communion together regularly, remembering and celebrating our risen Savior Jesus.

05 **Genuine community**

Cultivate genuine community through meals, conversation, and hospitality.

06 **Space to be known**

Allow space for prayer, encouragement, confession, and bearing one another's burdens.

07 **Grow through Scripture**

Study the Bible together or discuss the previous Sunday's message.

08 **Always welcoming**

Always be looking to welcome new people, to make disciples and build the church.

02

The rhythm

What a Wednesday night can look like, and what happens either side of it.

*You cannot be anonymous at
someone's kitchen table.*

An example of a night. Yours will look a little different.

This is a suggestion, not the play. What matters is that you have a plan and the group knows the shape of the evening before they arrive. Move the times to suit your home and your people, then give that time frame and stick to it. People will give you their Wednesday nights for a season if they know exactly what they are giving.

7:00

Eat

Doors open and the meal starts. This is not the warm-up to the real thing. It is half the point. Do not rush it.

7:45

Clear and connect

Table gets cleared together. This is where new people get folded in, so make sure nobody is standing on their own.

8:00

The Word

Study the Bible together or discuss Sunday's message. Dialogue, not monologue.

8:20

Communion and prayer

Take Communion together. Pray for one another out loud, by name.

8:30

Pray and send

Finish when you said you would. Honoring the clock honors people.

THE LEADER'S WEEK

Prep

Know what you are studying before Wednesday. Text the group midweek. Check who has been missing. Ten minutes on Monday saves the whole night.

Gather

Be ready before the first person arrives. Greet everyone at the door. Watch the room rather than the clock, and make sure the quietest person speaks at least once.

Follow up

Record attendance the same night. Text anyone who missed. Follow up anything raised in prayer, because the follow-up is where the shepherding happens.

If you would love kids to be welcome in your home, there are a few standards to work with.

Not every group will have children, and that is fine. If yours does, start with a conversation with the Lifegroups Director. We will walk through it with you, and if the standards below can be met, you are good to go.

THE STANDARD WE ALL KEEP

Any time a child is in the care of someone other than their own parent or guardian, two background-checked adults are present. It is the same standard in every Citipointe ministry, in every building and every home. It is not about suspicion — it protects the children and it protects you.

WHAT MEETS THE STANDARD

The simplest option: children stay with their own parents for the evening, in the same room or an adjoining one their parent can see. They eat with everyone and hear the adults pray.

If your group would like children looked after separately, that can work too — with two background-checked adults in the room. Talk to us and we will help you set it up.

WHERE TO CHECK FIRST

A single sitter, one adult alone with the kids in another room, or a rotating kids' night in another home all fall short of the standard — so bring those ideas to your oversight before you offer them, rather than after.

Arrangements families make privately between themselves stay with those parents. Lovely when it happens, simply not organized by the group.

WHEN SOMEONE ASKS, SAY THIS

"Bring the kids. They stay with you, they eat with us, and most nights they end up playing nearby while we talk. It is a family in a home, not a service."

However your group works it out, keep your Pastoral Oversight in the loop. Young Families oversight is Dylan and Tasmin Hibbert, and they would love to help.

Nobody caters this alone.

The food does not need to be impressive. It needs to happen. A slow cooker, a tray bake, something picked up on the way home. Nobody is being judged on the meal, and a simple table has never stopped anyone coming back.

Share the load. Find the people in your group who are passionate about hospitality, and let them carry the meal with you. Someone brings the main, everyone else works a simple rotation of sides, drinks, and dessert. Set that rotation for the whole season on night one, so it is one decision instead of a conversation every week.

Then hand it over. Give the rotation to someone in the group who enjoys organizing, and let them run it. If the host quietly absorbs the whole load they will be tired by week four and done by week eight, and the group loses its home. Sharing the meal is the first thing your group learns to share.

Ask about allergies and dietary needs when someone joins, not when they arrive at the door. Keep the list in your phone.

A GUEST'S FIRST NIGHT

Come hungry, bring nothing. That applies to a first visit. After that they are not a guest, they are family, and family brings something.

03

The standards

The non-negotiables. These are the same in every group, and they are what make a Lifegroup safe to send someone to.

COMMUNION THE 24 AND 48 HOUR RULES CONFIDENTIALITY
SAFEGUARDING CANCELLING AND OVERFLOW

Every gathering. Without exception.

Communion happens at every gathering. It is the single practice that keeps a dinner party from becoming just a dinner party.

You do not need to be ordained to serve it and you do not need to make it long. Bread and cup, a passage read out loud, a moment of quiet, and then pass it around the table.

The full step by step guide, with the Scriptures to read, is in the Leader Portal under the Communion guide. Use it from week one.

IF SOMEONE AT THE TABLE IS NOT YET A BELIEVER

Explain simply what Communion is and why we take it, invite them to take part, and make clear there is no pressure either way. Nobody is asked about their baptism and nobody is put on the spot. If they let it pass, they are just as welcome at the table, and it usually opens a good conversation later in the evening.

"Let a person examine himself, then, and so eat of the bread and drink of the cup."

1 CORINTHIANS 11:28

The 24 hour rule and the 48 hour rule.

24 Record attendance

Record attendance in the Citipointe USA app within 24 hours of every gathering. Under a minute, every week. It is how we spot someone drifting before they are gone: a person who misses three weeks in a row is telling us something, and the app is the only way we hear it in time to do anything about it.

If your group is not showing in the app, ask your Pastoral Oversight to add it before your first night.

48 Answer a join request

When someone requests to join your group, respond within 48 hours. They have already done the hard part by asking a room of strangers if they can come. Every hour of silence makes it harder to walk in the door.

Call if you can, text if you cannot. Give them the address, the time, and tell them the food is covered on their first night. If you cannot take them, tell your Pastoral Oversight the same day so they can be placed somewhere else.

ADDING SOMEONE TO YOUR GROUP

- 01 While your group is active and taking requests it is listed on citipointe.church. When someone clicks to join, you get a text and an email with their information. Reach out within 48 hours of that notification. If your group is full, notify the Lifegroups Director immediately.
- 02 Then add them manually in the Citipointe USA app so the records stay accurate. My Lifegroup, click your group, View / Edit Members, Add, search their name, add them in. You do not need to wait for a request: if you have already recruited someone, go straight to the app and add them.

Confidentiality is not secrecy.

What is shared around your table stays around your table. It is not repeated to other leaders, not repeated to spouses outside the group, and not carried into conversations at church on Sunday. There are three exceptions, and they are not negotiable.

01

Someone is at risk of harming themselves.

02

Someone is at risk of harming another person.

03

Anything involving a minor.

In those three cases you do not hold it, you do not sit on it overnight, and you do not decide on your own whether it is serious enough. You pass it to your Pastoral Oversight immediately, and where the law requires it, to the authorities. Tennessee requires any person who suspects child abuse or neglect to report it. That obligation is not limited to staff or to designated professionals, and it is not satisfied by telling a pastor.

WHAT BELONGS IN A NOTE

A note in the app records that care is happening and what needs to happen next. It is factual and brief.

WRITE

"Called Tuesday. Going through a hard season at work. Will follow up next week. Would benefit from a call from a pastor."

DO NOT WRITE

The content of what someone disclosed. Medical detail, marital detail, financial detail, or anything told to you in confidence that does not fall under the three exceptions.

If you are unsure whether something belongs in a note, it does not. Call your Pastoral Oversight and say it out loud instead.

If a child is in immediate danger, call 911 first. Then work down this list.

01 Your Pastoral Oversight

First call, always. Contacts are on page 20.

02 Kim Peterson, Lifegroups Director

kpeterson@citipointechurch.com

03 Dan Terry, Executive Pastor

628 259 9460. Day or night.

04 Safe Church Report form

In the Leader Portal. Submit it in every case, including cases already reported by phone, so there is a written record.

You are never the last line. If you are unsure whether something counts, that uncertainty is the reason to call, not a reason to wait.

Call your Pastoral Oversight before you cancel a night.

Life happens and nights get missed. But nine times out of ten there is a way to keep it running. Your co-leader can host. A leader in training can take the night. Someone else can open their home.

Cancelling is the fastest way to lose the momentum of a season, because it teaches the group that Wednesday is negotiable. Let it be the last option rather than the first.

WHEN YOUR GROUP IS FULL

We never turn anyone away.

When your table reaches capacity, tell the Lifegroups Director that same week. Do not wait for the next check-in. One of three things happens.

01

Your leaders in training launch a second table in another home.

02

We place the person in a group with room near them.

03

You sit down with the Lifegroups Director and plan how your group multiplies.

A full group is not a problem to be managed. It is the signal that it is time to multiply, which is what the two leaders in training were always for. Come and see the Lifegroups Director and we will work out the next step together.

04

The people

Who is behind you, what is yours to carry, and who comes next.

You have not finished leading until someone can lead without you.

PASTORAL OVERSIGHT WHAT IS YOURS AND WHAT IS OURS
RAISE A LEADER GROWING YOUR GROUP

PASTORAL OVERSIGHT

Your first call all year.

Start the relationship early, over coffee, before you need it.

NASHVILLE

YOUTH

Levi Winnington

YOUNG ADULTS

Kim and Chris Peterson

YOUNG FAMILIES

**Dylan and Tasmin
Hibbert**

ADULTS

Jimmy and Tishara Pitts

FRANKLIN

ALL LIFEGROUPS

Ethan and Emma-grace Sherrer

LIFEGROUPS DIRECTOR

Kim Peterson

kpeterson@citipointechurch.com

What is yours and what is ours.

You are a shepherd, not a counselor, not a crisis service, and not the last line. Here is where the line sits.

YOU HANDLE THIS

A hard week at work

A season of discouragement

Conflict between two people in the group

Someone drifting and not showing up

Questions about faith, doubt, or a passage nobody can make sense of

Practical need: a meal, a lift, a hand moving house

PASS TO PASTORAL OVERSIGHT

Marriage in trouble

Grief

Ongoing mental health struggle

Addiction

Financial crisis

Anything you have carried for more than a couple of weeks

Anything taking over the group's time

CALL IMMEDIATELY

Risk of harm to self

Risk of harm to another person

Anything involving a minor

Domestic violence

Any disclosure of abuse, current or historic

When you are unsure which column something belongs in, it belongs in the second. Call.

Every group carries two leaders in training.

You have not finished leading until someone can lead without you.

01

Spot the pattern

Look for the person who shows up early, notices needs without being asked, and lifts the room.

02

Invite them personally

Say it plainly. "I think you could lead this." Most future leaders are waiting to be asked.

03

Share the load

Hand over one real thing a month. The huddle, the discussion, the roster. Then coach from one step back.

04

Send them out

Recommend them to your Pastoral Oversight, then celebrate loudly when they launch their own table.

When someone is ready, tell your Pastoral Oversight. You are the pipeline for who leads next. A recommendation from you starts their approval, checks, and training.

Connected people connect people.

Successful leaders constantly invite new people, and encourage their members to do the same. People desire relationship.

Personal invitation

The best way to bring people in. Be present before and after service, and use the two-minute connect to go and get them. Do not assume people will just find your group.

Social media

Your personal page is a great way to share about your Lifegroup.

Your own circles

Members do not have to attend Citipointe. Invite coworkers, parents from your kids' teams, gym friends, the people already around you.

Do not do this alone

Build a team to share the load. Meals, set up, clean up.

05

Getting started

What to do between now and launch night on
Wednesday 2 September.

*Most future leaders are waiting to
be asked.*

NEW LEADER CHECKLIST
MY COMMITMENT

DISCIPLESHIP RESOURCES

THE LEADER PORTAL

Before your first night

- ☐ **Background check cleared**
Handled through CCB. Required before you lead anything. Submit by 19 August. Anyone not submitted by the 19th leads alongside an approved leader on launch night rather than solo.
- ☐ **Completed Heartbeat**
One Sunday. Learn the heart of the church before you lead in it.
- ☐ **Coffee with your Pastoral Oversight**
Start the relationship early. They are your first call all year.
- ☐ **Citipointe USA app access**
Ask your Pastoral Oversight to add your group so attendance recording works.

Your first month

- ☐ **Co-lead alongside a current leader**
Watch one, lead one. You are never thrown in alone.
- ☐ **Host a night with support**
Run the dinner table while your Pastoral Oversight or co-leader backs you up.
- ☐ **Record attendance the same night**
Under a minute in the app, every gathering. It is how we spot people drifting.
- ☐ **Take Communion together**
Use the guide. Keep Christ at the center from week one.

THE ONGOING RHYTHM

- ☐ **Stay consistent**
Same night, same rhythm. Consistency is what turns a gathering into a community.
- ☐ **Share the load**
Hand out real roles. Meals, prayer requests, hangouts. Involved people stay.
- ☐ **Check in on people who miss**
A quick text says you were missed.
- ☐ **Spot two you can train**
Every group raises two. Start praying about who.

This checklist also lives in the Leader Portal, where your ticks save on your device.

Discipleship is a life transaction. Teaching others everything Jesus has taught you.

MATTHEW 28:18-20

HOW TO MAKE A DISCIPLE

- 01 **Listen first, then ask questions.** Understand where they are coming from. The right question grows people faster than the right answer.
 - 02 **Teach truth and equip them.** Break the Word down where they are at, then show them how you study, pray, and practice the disciplines.
 - 03 **Be consistent in their life.** Connect outside the group. Groceries, hikes, your kitchen table. Discipleship is relationship.
 - 04 **Dig for gold.** Help people see themselves the way God sees them, and teach them the importance of being planted in the local church.
 - 05 **Love unconditionally.** Give grace and mercy as you address growth. The Holy Spirit changes hearts, not us.
-

PUT IN THEIR HANDS

New believers

The Following Jesus book and app, seven essentials with a video course, and the book of John, one chapter a day on YouVersion.

Going deeper

Theos U short courses and the Enduring Word commentary.

Topical books

Keep Your Love On by Danny Silk, Expanded Leadership by Mark Ramsey and Karolina Gunsser, and Secrets of the Secret Place.

This booklet is the launch. The portal is where you live all season.

Everything here is there, kept current, plus the things that do not fit in print.

GO TO

citipointe.church/leader-portal

PASSWORD

Serve2026

For approved Citipointe leaders.
Please do not share the password
outside the leadership team.

Lead a Lifegroup

The playbook, the run sheet, the standards, the Communion guide, curriculum and content.

Start here

The new leader checklist, with ticks that save on your device. Growing your group.

Raise a leader

The four-step succession process, and how to recommend someone.

Library

Training videos, hosting tips, and the Safe Church Report form.

TRAINING VIDEOS IN PRODUCTION

Your first night as a leader. Leading a discussion people remember. Pastoral care basics, what is yours and what is ours. Hosting the dinner table.

MY COMMITMENT

"Shepherd the flock of God that is among you, exercising oversight, not under compulsion, but willingly, as God would have you; not for shameful gain, but eagerly; not domineering over those in your charge, but being examples to the flock."

1 PETER 5:2-3

WHAT I COMMIT TO

- 01 I will lead with two approved leaders and raise two leaders in training.
- 02 I will keep Christ at the center, taking Communion together at every gathering.
- 03 I will shepherd the people at my table, following up in the week and not only on the night.
- 04 I will honor the church's pastors and leaders in both speech and action, and I will speak of the people in my group with the same honor.
- 05 I will hold the standards in this booklet, and I will call my Pastoral Oversight when I am unsure rather than deciding alone.

WHAT THE CHURCH COMMITS TO YOU

We will know you by name, not by group number.

Your Pastoral Oversight will initiate contact with you, and not wait for you to raise your hand.

We will answer you within 48 hours.

We will never leave you alone in a hard pastoral moment. You are not the last line.

We will tell you the truth about how your group is going, including when it is not going well.

NAME

SIGNED

DATE

Season: Fall 2026



The table is the strategy.

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citipointe.church

FOR THE GLORY OF GOD AND FOR THE SAKE OF THE WORLD